A couple of days later I got in our third-hand Oldsmobile and headed for the tri-cities, which were on the Mississippi River about seventy-five miles southwest of Dixon.

I started with stations on the Illinois side of the Mississippi but struck out, then crossed the river into Iowa. My first stop was station WOC in Davenport. In those days, the initials of radio stations' call signs usually meant something and WOC meant "World of Chiropractic."

The station had been founded by Colonel B. J. Palmer, proprietor of the Palmer School of Chiropractic, whose optimism and farsightedness about the future of radio had also led him to acquire Station WHO in Des Moines.

I'd learned during my job hunting in Chicago that if you wanted a job as a radio announcer, the person you applied to was the program director.

After finding the campus of the Palmer School of Chiropractic, an office building in downtown Davenport, I took the elevator to the top floor and asked to see the program director. A few seconds later I was shaking hands with a ruddy-faced Scotsman who was balancing himself on a spindly pair of canes.

Peter MacArthur had crossed the Atlantic as a song-and-dance man, a member of Harry Lauder's original vaudeville troupe, and toured America until arthritis nearly crippled him. Suffering terribly, he left the act in Davenport and went to the Palmer School of Chiropractic in hopes of finding relief from the cruel pain in his joints. He never found it, but his background in show business led to the offer of an announcer's job at WOC and later a job as program director. In that part of the country, Pete's Highland burr, as thick as oatmeal, was probably as familiar as the voices of Amos and Andy when he said: "WOC, Davenport—where the West begins, in the state where the tall corn grows."

Pete, whose cheeks had been burnished by the chilly winds of the Highlands until they were the color of copper,